



After the Mocks

A lesson for the week after mock results, in which each student separates what a result says from the story they have started telling themselves about it. Eight cards go on the tables and the class sorts them into facts and stories, then everyone writes their own result as one line of fact and one first move. It takes an hour, with one set of cards per table and one sheet per student. What they get is a way of reading a mark that leaves them with something to do rather than something to feel.

Before you start. A result can be tangled up with what is happening at home, and for a few students a bad mock lands on top of something much bigger. Nothing on the sheet is collected or read out, and the exit line asks what they would say to a friend with their result rather than what they think of themselves. A student who cannot face their own result can use the made-up one from slide 8.

Print these

Page	What it is	How many
Page 2	The eight cards	One set per table, cut once
Page 3	The sheet	One per student

The hour

Time	What happens	Slides
0 to 8	Title, then the cards. Each table sorts the eight into facts and stories; disagreements go on the board.	1 to 3
8 to 18	The two piles, what a result says, and what the story adds. The line to land is that a fact points somewhere and a story only points at you.	4 to 6
18 to 24	One result two ways, then the made-up result turned into a fact and a first move by the whole room.	7 to 8
24 to 34	Their own result on the sheet: what it tested, where the marks went, one line of fact, one first move under an hour.	9
34 to 40	Swap sheets. Partners underline any always, never or just, and mark a first move that is too big.	10
40 to 48	Two questions, one at a time. Who is a mock result for, and what is a mock actually for.	11
48 to 60	The week after: find out where the marks went, make the first move, tell one person. Then the exit line, private.	12 to 14

Worth knowing

- Two of the eight cards are meant to cause an argument, and a student who does not know where their marks went has a first move already: find out.

New resources go up on thepastoralguide.com as they are made. Leave your email there and you will hear when they do.





Facts and stories

Eight things people say in the week after results. One set per table, cut once. The table sorts them into two piles.

CARD 1

“I got a 4 in maths.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 2

“I am just not a maths person.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 3

“I ran out of time on paper two.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 4

“Everyone else found it easy.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 5

“I lost most of the marks on the last two questions.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 6

“There is no point now.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 7

“The topics I revised were not the ones that came up.”

Fact, or story?

CARD 8

“The teacher has it in for me.”

Fact, or story?





My result, as a fact

Pick one result, the one that bothers you most. Nothing on this sheet is collected or read out.

1. The result

The subject, the paper and the mark or grade.

2. What it tested

The topics, the kind of questions, the time it gave you.

3. Where the marks went

If you know. If you do not, your first move is to find out.

4. One line of fact

No always, never or just. If one gets in, cross it out and try again.

5. One first move

Under an hour, this week, and you could tell someone you had done it.

6. A friend got your result. What would you say to them?

Same mark, same paper. One sentence.

